TOPIC 1 · FUNDAMENTALS OF MICROSOFT 365 COPILOT
LAB 2 THEME · WORD TO POWERPOINT AND OUTLOOK

Lab 2 — Create the Cross-App Maintenance Update

Maps to	LO1: integrate verified Word, Excel, PowerPoint and Outlook outputs
Duration	30 minutes
Tools	Microsoft 365 Copilot · Excel · Word · PowerPoint · Outlook
Mock data	data/Northstar_Work_Orders.xlsx
Course	GenAI for Engineers · v2.4
Prompts	https://tertiarycourses.github.io/IES-GenAI-for-Engineers/prompts/#lab-2

Goal

Turn the Northstar operations brief into a 4-slide PowerPoint update and an Outlook email draft, then check that all three show the same numbers.

What You Will Build

Northstar_Initial_Update.pptx (4 slides) and an unsent Outlook email draft.

Prerequisites

- Microsoft 365 account with Copilot available in Word, Excel, PowerPoint and Outlook. Availability depends on the assigned licence and tenant settings; confirm access with the trainer before class.
- Desktop Excel on Windows or Mac. Download this lab folder and open the files straight from its data folder; save any new file in the same folder. All data is fictional.

Data note

Northstar Water Services is a fictional water-pipe maintenance and service company. All service hubs, staff and work orders are synthetic. Use the fixed reporting date 2026-09-30; missing facts remain UNKNOWN. Proposals do not change real assignments. Training email drafts are never sent.

Steps

Step 1. Read the brief. Open data/Northstar_Operations_Brief.docx in Word, open Copilot and send the prompt. You don’t need to select any text. The table should show 120 total, 60 backlog, 50 overdue and 6 unassigned.

PROMPT / CHECK — copy and adapt

```
WORD COPILOT:
Make a short table of the key numbers in this document: date, total, closed, cancelled,
backlog, overdue, unassigned backlog and cost. Show it here in the chat and don’t change the
document.
```

Step 2. Make the slides. Open data/templates/Northstar_Management_Deck_Template.pptx in PowerPoint and save it as Northstar_Initial_Update.pptx. In Copilot select + > Upload images and files and choose Northstar_Operations_Brief.docx from this lab’s data folder, then send the prompt.

PROMPT / CHECK — copy and adapt

```
POWERPOINT COPILOT:
Fill these 4 slides from the uploaded Northstar_Operations_Brief.docx: 1 scope and totals, 2
backlog and overdue work, 3 unassigned jobs and proposed actions, 4 the decision needed. Keep
the design and use only numbers from the brief.
```

Step 3. Check the slides. Send the prompt in the same chat, fix any wrong number on the slides and save.

PROMPT / CHECK — copy and adapt

```
POWERPOINT COPILOT:
Check these 4 slides against the uploaded brief. List any number that is wrong and give the correct number.
```

Step 4. Draft the email. In Outlook start a new email to operations.manager@example.invalid. Select Copilot > Draft with Copilot, paste the prompt and select Generate. Select Keep it, then close the email without sending it: it stays in your Drafts folder.

PROMPT / CHECK — copy and adapt

```
OUTLOOK COPILOT:
Write a short reply to the email below. Use these numbers for 30 September 2026: 120 total, 48 closed, 12 cancelled, 60 backlog, 50 overdue, 6 unassigned, cost S$35,827.50. Say what we found, what we propose next and what decision we need. Say that any new assignment is only a proposal, not approved.
EMAIL (fictional):
2026-09-29 09:00 Operations manager: Please prepare the 30 September portfolio snapshot; show open work by site, category and current assignment. 2026-09-29 10:15 Supervisor: Check overdue jobs before proposing reassignment. Available hours are planning inputs, not approval. 2026-09-30 08:30 Analyst: The source export is in the workbook. No new assignment has been approved. Please produce a Word brief and a short PowerPoint update, then prepare a draft reply.
```

Step 5. Compare all three. The brief, the slides and the email must show the same numbers. Fix anything that is different.

PROMPT / CHECK — copy and adapt

```
Total : 120
Backlog : 60
Overdue : 50
Unassigned : 6
Cost : S$35,827.50
```

Copy buttons for every prompt: https://tertiarycourses.github.io/IES-GenAI-for-Engineers/prompts/#lab-2

Test It

Check	Expected result
Same numbers	Brief, slides and email all show 120 total, 60 backlog, 50 overdue and 6 unassigned.
Draft only	The email stays in Drafts; nothing is approved.

Troubleshooting

If this happens	Fix
Copilot cannot see my file	In Excel, save the file and open Copilot again. In Word, PowerPoint or Outlook, upload the file with + > Upload images and files, and upload it again after you change it.
A number is different from the lab	Clear any slicers or filters, check the table has no extra rows, then ask again in a new chat.
A button or feature is missing	Check you are signed in with your course account and Microsoft 365 is up to date, then tell your trainer.

Challenge

Repeat the task for one different site and explain how the filter scope changes the result. Keep the original verified output.

Reflection

Which evidence proves the output is correct, and which decision still needs a person?